# Cameron Park, California

*In Cameron Park, El Niño's danger is a foothill outage that runs for days, in homes where the heat stops with the power. Older people live alone, generators get run in garages, and oxygen machines lose power. The most important step is to reach the 345 residents who depend on powered medical equipment before December, with backup that lasts longer than an afternoon.*

| IMPACT REGION | EXCESS HEAT DEATHS | WINDOW | DOMINANT HAZARD |
|---|---|---|---|
| El Dorado County, CA (inferred) | None published for the US, California, or the county | n/a here; global 6-month figure 239,000 ± 11,000 | Multi-day PG&E outages from trees and snow; creek flooding at Deer Creek and Cameron Park Lake; a fire window until the first soaking rain |

**12/12 recommendations checked.** 3 confirmed, 8 corrected, 1 unverified, 0 contraindicated. No action proposed here would do harm as corrected. The verifiers did refute one Skeptic claim: that PG&E's backup-power rebate rarely applies here. CPUC fire-threat districts cover about 56% of the Cameron Park area. The funding placements were checked separately. One option, 1 kWh batteries as an oxygen user's only backup, is ruled out because they last about three hours. **The funding target fell 27%**, from $310k to $225k, which is within the one-third tolerance. Exposure: Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE




38.67°N 120.98°W, United States of America · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** A foothill outage can run for days in homes where the heat stops with the power: 345 residents depend on powered medical equipment, older people live alone, and generators get run in garages.
- **First action.** El Dorado County Public Health, PG&E, and FREED reach the 345 residents on powered medical equipment, with batteries and oxygen plans in place by 1 December.*
- **The money.** $85k floor, $225k target, $540k ceiling; the floor buys 40 batteries at $1,500 and 500 alarms at $50.
- **Do not.** Do not give an oxygen user a small battery and call them covered: a 1 kWh unit runs a 300 W concentrator for about three hours.*


| | | |
|---|---|---|
| What to do | **9** actions | p. 2 |
| Who does what | RACI chart | p. 11 |
| Where money does the most | funding | p. 11 |
| Do not do this | **1** item | p. 13 |
| What has happened here | the record | p. 13 |
| How this was produced | methodology | p. 15 |
| References | sources | p. 16 |

Risk, September 2026, pre-peer-review. It publishes no figure for the United States, California, or El Dorado County, and heat is not this place's winter hazard. No population-scaled figure is given here. Research limit: the web-search quota ran out during this run, so lenses and verifiers worked largely by fetching primary pages and data services directly. Unchecked items are marked.

**Read this first: in Cameron Park, an outage takes the heat with it.** Of 7,624 occupied homes, 42% heat with electricity and 38% with propane, whose furnaces need power to run their blowers. Only 9% use utility gas and 4% wood. A multi-day outage therefore leaves most homes unheated, which is when generators move into garages and camp stoves come indoors. The outages here run for days, not hours. On 4 January 2022, about 18,350 PG&E Sierra Division customers were still dark after the December storms, because snow and fallen trees kept crews from even reaching the damage. No storm death in El Dorado County was found for 2021–2023, but the search was cut short, so treat that as “not found”, not “none”. The deaths to plan against would be recorded as heart, lung, and carbon-monoxide deaths days into an outage, among 4,273 residents aged 65 or over (23.3%), 1,056 of whom live alone.

## WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO

RANKED

Actions are ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. The backing lenses are shown on each action, and the RACI chart below assigns each one. One rule underlies every action: trigger on individual storm, wind, and snow forecasts, not on the season. The worst

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

recent winters here (December 2021 and 2022–23) were La Niña winters, and the strong 2015–16 El Niño largely missed Northern California.

## 1. Reach the 345 residents on powered medical equipment, check them for a DDAR battery, and give oxygen users backup that lasts days

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MGR · ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST · FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| El Dorado County Public Health (emPOWER named list); PG&E (Medical Baseline); DDAR battery intake through FREED Center for Independent Living; dialysis units | Enrolment in October–November; batteries and oxygen plans by 1 Dec | ~$105k for 70 batteries (see funding); enrolment is staff and volunteer time | Deaths from failed oxygen concentrators and home equipment, and from missed dialysis, during outages lasting days |

HHS emPOWER, re-queried by the verifier on 8 October 2026: ZIP 95682 has 8,203 Medicare beneficiaries, of whom 345 use electricity-dependent equipment, 55 are on oxygen, 21 are on dialysis, and 11 are in home hospice. PG&E's Medical Baseline programme adds outage alerts, which “may include multiple texts, phone calls or even a door-bell ring,” and a discount on some rates. PG&E's Portable Battery Program “has reached capacity for 2026,” and it only takes customers with a wildfire shutoff or three or more fire-safety (EPSS) outages since 2024. DDAR, the disability programme, still offers batteries to people in a CPUC High Fire-Threat District, and about 56% of the Cameron Park area is in one. So screen every device user for DDAR first, and fund a pool only for those it misses. Batteries are a bridge: a 2 kWh unit runs a 300 W oxygen concentrator for about six hours, so oxygen users also need cylinders from their supplier and a plan to move down the hill before a big storm. Ask dialysis units to bring sessions forward before each forecast storm.*

Corrections: DDAR's own directory and PG&E's county list name FREED Center for Independent Living (Grass Valley, 530-477-3333) for El Dorado and Placer counties, although FREED's own website lists only five other counties. Placer Independent Resource Services (Auburn) is the local independent living centre but is not a DDAR centre. Confirm intake with FREED before granting. PG&E's rebate battery option (action 4) is limited to 290–1,000 Wh, so a 2 kWh unit does not qualify for it. The emPOWER ZIP is labelled “Shingle Springs” and covers

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about 78 square miles, so the 345 are not all in Cameron Park. Evidence: early dialysis before Hurricane Sandy was associated with lower 30-day mortality (Lurie et al., *AJKD* 2015, 66:507–512; OR 0.72, 95% CI 0.52–0.997). That is observational, from one hurricane, with the upper bound close to 1.

## 2. Install carbon-monoxide alarms, and make one rule stick: generators outside, 20 feet from the house, never in the garage

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE · PHILANTHROPIST · ECONOMIST | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Cameron Park CSD fire department (CAL FIRE-staffed) with the Greater Cameron Park Fire Safe Council and volunteers | Before the first atmospheric river; message out by 1 Nov | ~$50k for 1,000 alarms installed (see funding) | CO deaths from generators, propane heaters, and camp stoves used indoors during outages |

The heating mix above makes this the classic outage killer here. In Connecticut's October 2011 storm outages, 72 CO incidents caused 133 cases and 3 deaths, and generator or charcoal misuse caused 83% of the incidents (Styles et al., 2015). Detectors could have prevented about half of 136 unintentional CO deaths in New Mexico (Yoon et al., *JAMA* 1998, a modelled estimate). Install alarms, rather than hand them out, and target the 231 mobile homes and the households buying generators.*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the fire department is part of the Cameron Park Community Services District, so the CSD and the fire department are one channel, not two. The 231 mobile homes are counted out of all 7,967 housing units, not occupied units. That a furnace blower needs power is engineering logic, not a measured figure. No generator CO death in El Dorado County was found for December 2021 or 2023 (one search only), so no local death is cited.

## 3. Build a check-in list and phone tree for the 1,056 people aged 65 or over who live alone, using landlines as well as mobiles

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Cameron Park CSD Senior Activities (2502 Country Club Dr); Greater Cameron Park Fire Safe Council; block volunteers | List and phone tree by 15 Nov | Volunteer time; printed outage cards | Older people alone and unchecked on day three to five of an outage |

From the 2020–24 ACS for Cameron Park CDP (18,315 people), checked by the verifier: 4,273 residents are aged 65 or over and 1,056 live alone. One volunteer calls five isolated neighbours on day one of any outage longer than 24 hours. At the door, sign people up for the county's alerts: Smart911, through ready.eldoradosheriff.gov, and their Perimeter evacuation zone. Evidence: during California's fall 2019 shutoffs, emergency visits rose by 15 per 100,000 people aged 65 and over on the most exposed days (Harding et al., 2026). The 2003 New York blackout raised non-accidental deaths by 25% (95% CI 12–41%; Anderson & Bell, *Epidemiology* 2012). Check-in programmes have no effect size of their own.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the county alert system is Smart911 (a Rave product) plus Perimeter zones, not Genasys. That Cameron Park Mobile Home Estates is a 55+ park is unverified. Cell-site failure in long outages is plausible but was not quantified here; the FCC's October 2019 figures could not be fetched.

## 4. Claim PG&E's backup-power rebate before 31 December, battery first, after checking the address on PG&E's map

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · SKEPTIC | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Households; CSD and Fire Safe Council to publicise it; PG&E as payer | Purchases and claims by 31 Dec 2026 | Up to $300 per account from PG&E, plus up to $200 for CARE or FERA households | Households left with no backup, or with only a generator and no alarm |

The rebate is paid by PG&E ratepayers to customers whose address is in a CPUC High Fire-Threat District (Tier 2 or 3), a High Fire Risk Area, or on an EPSS circuit. The verifier queried the CPUC map: the districts cover about 56% of Cameron Park CDP (Tier 2 26%, Tier 3 31%) and about 70% of ZIP 95682. The dense core tested as outside, so this is “check your address,” not a blanket claim. Steer people to the battery option (290–1,000 Wh) first, because a generator bought without a CO alarm adds to the risk in action 2.*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Correction: the free Backup Power Transfer Meter is closed for 2026 (fully subscribed; it reopens in January 2027). The Skeptic's warning that the rebate rarely applies here did not hold up.

## 5. Clear the culverts on Deer Creek below Cameron Park Lake before the first storm, and have the low lots buy flood insurance by 31 October

CONFIRMED | HISTORIAN · FRONTLINE · ECONOMIST | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| El Dorado County Department of Transportation and the CSD (culverts and drainage); residents of Piper Ct, Salida Way, Bonanza Dr, and Air Park Estates | Culverts before the first atmospheric river; insurance bought by 31 Oct for cover from 1 Dec | Existing maintenance; premiums paid by households | People trapped by fast creek flooding at night; uninsured losses |

On New Year's Eve 2022 the Sheriff ordered evacuations where Deer Creek meets Cameron Park Lake: Piper Ct, Salida Way, Bonanza Dr, and Air Park Estates. One family was displaced for about three and a half weeks. OpenFEMA records three NFIP claims in ZIP 95682 for that date, about $276k in total, and one was rated Zone X, outside the mapped flood zone. NFIP policies take effect after 30 days. Check homeowner policies too: in 2023, 15.2% of renewal decisions in the ZIP were non-renewals, and 9.0% of dwellings were on the California FAIR Plan in 2022. FAIR Plan base cover is fire, lightning, internal explosion, and smoke. Windstorm is added only if “Extended Coverages” is ticked on the declarations, and no FAIR form covers weight of snow, a tree falling without wind, or frozen pipes; only a difference-in-conditions policy fills those gaps (verified for the Pollock Pines briefing the same day).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: CDI labels ZIP 95682 “Shingle Springs,” so the insurance figures cover Cameron Park and Shingle Springs together, and the three NFIP claims could not be tied to Cameron Park itself. A firefighter rescue of a trapped family appears only in a search summary and is dropped.

## 6. Confirm which building is Cameron Park's warming and charging site, and that it has backup power, before telling anyone to go there

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| El Dorado County OES with Cameron Park CSD (community center, 530-677-2231) | Answer by 1 Nov; transfer switch fitted by 15 Nov if needed | A phone call; a transfer switch is ~$8–15k per site (unsourced estimate) | A warming centre that is itself dark, as happened in 2021 |

In the December 2021 – January 2022 storms PG&E had to put temporary power at 11 sites in its Sierra Division, including hospitals, warming centres, and substations. A warming site that depends on the grid fails exactly when it is needed. Cameron Park sits on the west side of the county, where US-50 to Sacramento normally stays open, so a powered local site is realistic.

Unverified: whether the county designates the Cameron Park Community Center as a warming or resource site, and whether it has backup power. Neither the CSD nor the county site mentions it.

## 7. Prune or remove trees over service drops and roofs before December

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN · PUBLIC HEALTH | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Households and arborists; PG&E vegetation management for lines; Fire Safe Council for elderly or disabled residents | Before December | At owners' cost; unpriced | Trees through roofs, and service drops torn down so that one home stays dark after the circuit is restored |

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Foothill snow outages in February 2019 ran about eight days for some El Dorado County households. Trees on lines are what make the outages long: in 2021 they stopped crews from reaching the damage at all. Stay off the roads during wind and snow warnings, since vehicles are where most US tree-fall deaths happen (44% in Schmidlin, *Natural Hazards* 2009).

Corrections: the February 2019 article names Pollock Pines, not Cameron Park. PG&E's post-2023 figures (4,940 poles, 13,263 trees) and the feeder names in the lens report could not be verified and are dropped.

## 8. Plan for Cameron Park as the receiving area when US-50 closes upstream, and keep 30 days of prescriptions at home

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED (REFRAMED) · EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN · INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| El Dorado County OES (tabletop exercise); households and pharmacies | Tabletop by 15 Nov | Staff time | Being unready to shelter and supply people from the cut-off upper county |

In January 1997 US-50 closed for 17 days for flooding, then for 28 days (24 January to 21 February) after a slide east of Riverton. Both closures were in the South Fork American River canyon, far east of Placerville.

Correction: a canyon closure does not isolate Cameron Park, which keeps US-50 west to Sacramento. The lens's "Cameron Park cut off" drill is reframed: Cameron Park is the staging and receiving area for Pollock Pines and the upper county. A 30-day supply of medicine is still sensible on outage grounds.

## 9. Have County OES ask the Governor for an emergency proclamation naming El Dorado County within a day of a major storm

CONFIRMED · ECONOMIST · INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| El Dorado County OES and Board of Supervisors | Request drafted now; sent within a day of a damaging storm | ~$0 | Disconnections and lost deposits for households recovering from a storm |

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

PG&E's disaster protections switch on only after a Governor's or President's emergency declaration: disconnections are suspended, deposits and late fees waived, REACH assistance of up to $1,100 is available, and payment plans are offered, for 12 months. A county proclamation alone does not trigger them, and the CARE review freeze applies only in counties the declaration names.

Unverified: whether County OES already has a same-day request procedure.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

## RACI CHART

**R** = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

| Action | County Public Health | County OES | PG&E | FREED (DDAR centre) | Dialysis units | Cameron Park CSD & Fire | Fire Safe Council | County DOT | El Dorado Community Foundation | Households & block volunteers |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1. Power-dependent residents: named list, Medical Baseline, DDAR screen, batteries, oxygen and dialysis plans | **A** | **C** | **R** | **R** | **R** | **C** | | | **C** | **R** |
| 2. CO alarms installed; generators outside | **C** | | **I** | | | **A** | **R** | | **C** | **R** |
| 3. Check-in list and phone tree for people 65+ living alone; Smart911 and Perimeter sign-up | **C** | **C** | | | | **A/R** | **R** | | | **R** |
| 4. PG&E backup-power rebate claimed by 31 Dec, battery first | | | **R** | | | **A** | **R** | | | **R** |
| 5. Deer Creek culverts cleared; flood insurance for low lots | | **C** | | | | **R** | | **A/R** | | **R** |
| 6. Powered warming site confirmed | **C** | **A** | **C** | | | **R** | | | **C** | **I** |
| 7. Trees over service drops and roofs | | | **R** | | | **C** | **R** | | | **A/R** |
| 8. Receiving-area tabletop; 30 days of prescriptions | **C** | **A/R** | **C** | | **C** | **R** | | **C** | | **R** |
| 9. Same-day request for a Governor's proclamation | **I** | **A/R** | **I** | | | **I** | | | | **I** |

What the chart shows. **The Cameron Park CSD, which includes the fire department, is accountable on three of nine rows and does the work on four**. Its fire contract with CAL FIRE is “under review” and its reserves are being spent down, so its capacity is the plan's biggest dependency. **The first action depends on a centre outside the county**: FREED, the DDAR centre for El Dorado County, is in Grass Valley. **County OES owns the two cheapest actions** (rows 8 and 9), both of which are paperwork.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

## FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs.

| FLOOR | TARGET | CEILING | LARGEST UNCERTAINTY |
|---|---|---|---|
| $85k | $225k | $540k | How many device users DDAR already covers, because much of Cameron Park is in a fire-threat district |

**Floor:** 40 batteries × $1,500 = $60k, plus 500 alarms × $50 = $25k, for $85k. **Target:** 70 batteries × $1,500 = $105k, plus 1,000 alarms × $50 = $50k, plus food boxes $20k and the Foundation reserve $50k, for $225k. **Ceiling:** 200 × $1,500 = $300k, plus 2,000 × $50 = $100k, plus 1,000 boxes × $40 = $40k, plus a $100k reserve, for $540k. The target fell 27% in verification, from $310k, because batteries were

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

concentrated on the 55 oxygen users and food boxes were demoted. The $1,500 battery (about 2 kWh, delivered) and $50 installed alarm are estimates, not quotes.

| RECIPIENT | USE | AMOUNT | MECHANISM | BASIS | VERDICT |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FREED Center for Independent Living (DDAR centre for El Dorado; FY25 revenue $3.63M) | Action 1: ~2 kWh batteries for oxygen and device users that DDAR and PG&E miss | $105k | Restricted grant; pre-positioned stock | 70 × ~$1,500, prioritising the 55 oxygen users, as a bridge to cylinders. Screen out existing DDAR recipients | PARTIALLY CONFIRMED |
| Greater Cameron Park Fire Safe Council (rather than the CSD, whose fire budget is under strain) | Action 2: CO alarms installed, generator briefings at propane points of sale | $50k | Direct grant | 1,000 × ~$50 installed ($25–35 alarm plus volunteer fitting). The council's capacity was not verified | PARTIALLY CONFIRMED |
| El Dorado Community Foundation (2024 revenue $6.67M; assets $34.5M) | Rapid-response reserve: transport to a powered warming site, hotel nights for device users | $50k | Pooled fund | Well within capacity; ask for its Caldor grant record to confirm payout speed | PARTIALLY CONFIRMED |
| Food Bank of El Dorado County (Cameron Park; 2024 revenue $4.19M) | Shelf-stable boxes for homebound seniors, coordinated with senior nutrition | $20k (was $60k) | Pre-positioned stock | 500 × $40. Demoted: hunger is not what kills in a 2–5 day outage | PARTIALLY CONFIRMED |
| (any) | 1 kWh batteries as an oxygen user's only backup | $0 | n/a | Runs a 300 W concentrator for about 3 hours against outages lasting days | RULED OUT |

**The funder's one thing:** the utility's own battery programme is full for 2026, and the cheapest life-saving dollar here goes to the device users that it, and DDAR, have left out. One request decides how big that line should be: ask PG&E and the DDAR centre for their count of Medical Baseline customers in ZIP 95682 who have no battery. Do it before Thanksgiving. And do not fund generators: the rebate already pays for backup, and a generator without an alarm is the CO risk in action 2.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

DO NOT DO THIS — CONTRAINDICATED

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives or waste the window here.

### Give an oxygen user a small battery and call them covered*

RULED OUT IN VERIFICATION

One lens proposed 1 kWh units at about $800 for the 55 oxygen users. A 1 kWh unit runs a 300 W concentrator for about three hours. Outages here have run for days: about eight days in February 2019 and more than a week into January 2022.

**Instead:** fund about 2 kWh units as a bridge, require a cylinder supply from the patient's medical-equipment provider, and agree in advance where the person goes if the outage lasts more than a day.

**No action proposed for Cameron Park was found contraindicated as corrected.** Also avoid (lens advice, consistent with verified evidence): giving away or promoting generators without an installed CO alarm and a placement rule; warning systems that rely on mobile phones alone; warming sites that require a long drive on storm roads; and selling this as an “El Niño campaign,” when the worst recent winters were La Niña winters. The generator point is supported by the verified CO evidence; the others were not separately verified.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

| YEAR | EVENT | TOLL | WHAT CHANGED AFTER |
|---|---|---|---|
| Jan–Feb 1997 | New Year's floods; US-50 closed 17 days, then 28 days for a slide east of Riverton | No local deaths found | A permanent signed detour (“Alt 50”) via Sly Park Rd and Mormon Emigrant Trail |
| Sep 2014 | King Fire, set at Pollock Pines | 97,717 acres; 80 structures; 2,830 evacuated; no deaths | No Cameron Park orders recorded |
| Feb 2019 | Foothill snowstorm | Some El Dorado County households ~8 days without power | None recorded |

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

| YEAR | EVENT | TOLL | WHAT CHANGED AFTER |
|---|---|---|---|
| Aug 2021 | Caldor Fire | 53,000+ under evacuation orders in the county; ~1,003 structures; no civilian deaths | No Cameron Park orders recorded |
| Dec 2021 – Jan 2022 | Snow and atmospheric rivers (state emergency); La Niña winter | ~18,350 Sierra Division customers still out on 4 Jan; crews blocked by trees and snow | PG&E temporary generation at 11 sites |
| 31 Dec 2022 | Deer Creek floods at Cameron Park Lake; Sheriff's evacuation order | One family displaced ~3.5 weeks; 3 NFIP claims (~$276k) in the ZIP | Residents sandbagged into spring 2023 |
| Jan – Mar 2023 | Atmospheric rivers in a La Niña winter | Sacramento County next door: 2 killed by trees, 3 on flooded roads | None recorded locally |

**The recurrence nobody has noticed:** Cameron Park's evacuation orders have come from water, not fire. The two big fires of the last decade, King and Caldor, burned to the east and never ordered Cameron Park out. The one confirmed order here was the Deer Creek flood of New Year's Eve 2022, in a La Niña winter, in streets where one flood claim was outside the mapped flood zone. Residents and plans both treat this as fire country. The winter record says to watch the creek.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **Point people to PG&E's backup-power rebate** (Economist) versus **don't, because eligibility is tied to fire risk** (Skeptic). The CPUC map query settled it for most addresses: about 56% of the area qualifies. The report keeps the rebate, with “check your address” and battery first.
- **A small battery for each oxygen user** (Economist) versus **a larger unit for fewer people** (Philanthropist, verification). The larger unit wins on the outage record.
- **US-50 closure as Cameron Park's risk** (Emergency manager, Historian) versus **closures are upstream** (verification). The action is reframed as a receiving-area plan.
- **Plan for El Niño** versus **the signal is weak this far north** (Skeptic, Historian, Public health). The report acts on each forecast storm.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

## WHAT NOBODY COVERED

BLIND SPOT

No lens looked at **well water**: rural parcels on the edges of the ZIP may lose water when the pump loses power. No lens covered **care homes and assisted-living residences**, or the **Spanish-speaking** residents (15% of the population are Hispanic) beyond a mention of Spanish alert flyers. No lens examined the **residential airpark**, where aviation fuel is stored next to homes in a flood-prone corner of town.

## HOW TO READ THIS

METHOD

**The panel is author-built.** Seven simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale, roughly 300,000 people, and are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; drought, flood, fire, smoke, and crop failure are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

## HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED

METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The request named “Cameron Park, CA”, an unincorporated census-designated place of about 18,300 people. Climate Impact Lab impact region, as this report records it: El Dorado County, CA (about 192,000 people), *inferred* rather than resolved on the Impact Map. Demographic figures are for the CDP. Medical-device and insurance figures are for ZIP 95682, which also covers Shingle Springs and rural land (about 78 square miles).
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Heat is not this place's winter hazard, so the historical record carries the hazard instead.
- **Expert panel.** Seven simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, and philanthropist) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias before it counted: two lenses converged on US-50 closure as a Cameron Park risk, and verification placed the closures upstream. Contradictions were kept, including the rebate disagreement. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, given payers or marked unfunded, and reconciled against the funding placements.
- **Verification.** Five separate verifier agents checked 12 recommendations and the funding placements on evidence, transferability, and feasibility. Financial actions were also checked for availability, a named payer, a trigger, and whether they are already implemented. Verifiers queried HHS emPOWER, the CPUC High Fire-Threat District layer, the CDI insurance files, OpenFEMA NFIP claims, and the Census Reporter API directly. The envelope was re-summed.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Consulted earlier the same day (8 October 2026) by driving the inventory's map interface in a browser for the Elmwood briefing; the US filter returns 19 entries, none covering power-dependent residents, CO alarms, check-in lists, utility rebates, or creek drainage. It was not re-driven for this location. Actions are tagged “none found” on that basis.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (oxygen, dialysis, and medical equipment in an outage, and generators and carbon monoxide) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total. Retail and lens cost estimates are labelled as such. No local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. **The shared web-search quota ran out early in this run**, so most findings come from directly fetched pages and data services, and the El Dorado County storm-death record, the warming-site designation, and the CO-death record could not be checked. ABC10, KCRA, and Mountain Democrat pages refused fetches.

References · verified by Phase 5 unless marked. HHS emPOWER, ZIP 95682 (queried 8 Oct 2026) · Census Reporter, Cameron Park CDP (verified) · ACS heating fuel and housing type (queried) · PG&E Medical Baseline (verified) · PG&E Portable Battery Program (verified) · PG&E DDAR (verified) · PG&E county support list (verified) · DDAR get services (verified) · FREED, IRS filings (verified) · FAIR Plan dwelling policy form (verified, Pollock Pines run) · Lurie et al. 2015 (verified) · Styles et al. 2015, Connecticut CO (verified) · Yoon et al. 1998 (verified) · Anderson & Bell

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2012 (verified) · Harding et al. 2026, PSPS ED visits (verified) · Cameron Park CSD (verified) · Cameron Park Fire (verified) · El Dorado County Fire Safe Council (verified) · El Dorado County alerts (Smart911, Perimeter) (verified) · PG&E Generator and Battery Rebate (verified) · PG&E transfer meter (verified, closed for 2026) · CPUC High Fire-Threat District layer (queried) · PG&E disaster customer protections (verified) · CDI non-renewals by ZIP (verified) · CDI FAIR Plan share by ZIP (verified) · California FAIR Plan dwelling policy (verified) · OpenFEMA NFIP claims, 95682 (queried) · Cameron Park flood evacuation, Dec 2022 (verified) · Cameron Park residents, Feb 2023 (verified) · Sierra outages, Jan 2022 (verified) · El Dorado outages, Feb 2019 (corrected) · Schmidlin 2009 (verified, Curtis Park run) · US-50 in California (verified) · Caldor Fire (verified) · King Fire (verified) · Cameron Park (lens) · El Dorado Community Foundation, IRS filings (verified) · Food Bank of El Dorado County, IRS filings (verified) · El Dorado outages, Jan 2023 (lens) · 2022–23 California floods (lens)

Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory (US)

Generated 8 October 2026 for Cameron Park, California. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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